



Youths For Green Action Kenya (YGAK)

Email: youthsaction31@gmail.com

Contact: 0748204272 / 0706072692

Address: Nakuru, Kenya

Greening Schools Initiative Report — Phase Four (Homa Bay County).

Prepared by: Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK)

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Executive Summary.

On 19th October 2025, Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) successfully implemented the fourth phase of the Greening Schools Initiative in Rachuonyo North Sub-County, Homa Bay County. A total of 35,000 tree seedlings were distributed and planted across seven schools as part of YGAK's ongoing mission to restore degraded landscapes, promote environmental awareness among learners, and advance climate action through school-based greening programs.

The seedlings planted comprised purely indigenous species — *Bischofia javanica*, *Prunus africana*, *Mahamia lutea*, *Croton silvatica*, *Podocarpus*, and *Syzygium* — selected for their drought tolerance, ecological value, and suitability for the dry climatic conditions of Homa Bay County. This phase demonstrated YGAK's expertise in climate-smart reforestation, reinforcing its vision of empowering youth as key drivers of sustainable development and environmental resilience.

Introduction.

Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) is an environmental organization dedicated to reforestation, conservation, climate action, and sustainable community engagement. The Greening Schools Initiative (GSI) aims to integrate tree planting and environmental education into learning institutions, transforming schools into living classrooms for sustainability and climate action. This report documents the activities, outcomes, challenges, and recommendations from the Homa Bay County phase conducted in October 2025.

Objectives of the Initiative.

- To increase tree cover through school-based reforestation programs.
- To instill environmental stewardship and climate awareness among learners.
- To strengthen partnerships between schools, communities, and environmental actors.
- To support Kenya's broader climate action and reforestation goals.

Seedling Distribution Data.

School Name	Sub-County	No. of Seedlings	Type of Seedlings	Date
Ong'ang Primary School	Rachuonyo North	5,000	Bischofia, Prunus africana,	19th Oct 2025
Ong'ang Secondary School	Rachuonyo North	5,000	Mahamia lutea, Croton	19th Oct 2025
Kowuor Secondary School	Rachuonyo North	5,000	Podocarpus, Syzygium	19th Oct 2025
Kowuor Primary School	Rachuonyo North	5,000	Bischofia, Syzygium	19th Oct 2025
Kamollo Primary School	Rachuonyo North	5,000	Croton silvatica,	19th Oct 2025
Kamollo Secondary School	Rachuonyo North	5,000	Bischofia, Syzygium	19th Oct 2025
Kunya Primary School	Rachuonyo North	5,000	Podocarpus, Syzygium	19th Oct 2025

Totals

Number of Schools: 7

Total Seedlings Distributed: 35,000

County Covered: Homa Bay (Rachuonyo North Sub-County)

Achievements.

- 35,000 seedlings distributed and planted in seven learning institutions.
- Enhanced integration of environmental education within school programs and clubs.
- Strengthened collaboration among schools, YGAK, local administration, and community members.
- Promotion of indigenous species and climate-resilient reforestation practices.
- Sustained collaboration and unwavering support from long-term partners and sponsors — *German Imaging Technologies (GIT), The Design Gallery, and Victoria Furnitures Ltd.* Their consistent commitment, funding, and encouragement have been instrumental to the success of the 2025 program year, reinforcing YGAK's credibility, impact, and continuity in advancing reforestation and climate action across Kenya.

Challenges and Mitigation.

The Homa Bay region experiences prolonged dry seasons and generally arid conditions, which posed a significant challenge for the survival and establishment of young seedlings.

However, YGAK leveraged this challenge as an opportunity to apply its environmental expertise by selecting purely indigenous tree species known for their resilience, adaptability, and ecological compatibility.

Rationale for Indigenous Species Selection.

1. *Bischofia javanica*: Strong root system and high adaptability to varying soil moisture levels.
2. *Prunus africana*: Thrives in well-drained soils and tolerates moderate dry spells.
3. *Mahamia lutea*: Fast-growing and improves soil moisture retention through deep root systems.
4. *Croton silvatica*: Hardy and adaptable to dry, open environments with minimal water needs.
5. *Podocarpus*: Evergreen species tolerant to fluctuating rainfall and extended dry periods.
6. *Syzygium*: Resilient and capable of thriving in both moderately dry and wet environments.

Recommendations and Way Forward (Year-End Review 2025).

As Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) concludes the 2025 implementation cycle of the Greening Schools Initiative, this year's activities provide valuable insights into both our progress and areas requiring strategic improvement. The Homa Bay phase, like previous ones, revealed the organization's strong commitment to environmental restoration, youth engagement, and partnerships — yet also highlighted practical challenges that inform our approach for the coming year.

Strengths Observed:

- Strong collaboration with schools, teachers, and local communities, demonstrating growing trust and ownership of YGAK's initiatives.
- Successful mobilization and planting of 35,000 indigenous seedlings.
- Effective integration of environmental education sessions into learning institutions.
- Consistency and expansion across counties, marking steady progress toward the 1-million-tree target.
- Maintained collaboration and strengthened relationships with long-term partners and sponsors — *German Imaging Technologies (GIT), The Design Gallery, and Victoria Furnitures Ltd* has reinforced the organization's ability to deliver impactful and trusted environmental programs across Kenya.

Weaknesses and Areas for Improvement:

- Lengthy administrative procedures and delayed approvals from county and education offices.
- Limited post-planting monitoring due to logistical and budget constraints.
- Inconsistent seedling survival rates in drier zones like Homa Bay, calling for more robust aftercare systems.

Recommendations & Next Steps (2026):

1. **Strengthen Early Coordination:** Initiate early engagement with county education and forestry departments to streamline approval and logistical processes ahead of each phase.
2. **Enhance Monitoring Systems:** Introduce structured follow-up visits for tracking of tree survival to assess impact and improve accountability.
3. **Expand Awareness Campaigns:** Scale up community and school-based sensitization programs emphasizing indigenous species, climate resilience, and sustainable land restoration.
4. **Build Capacity:** Provide training sessions for teachers, student leaders, and community volunteers on tree care, climate adaptation, and environmental stewardship.
5. **Strengthen and Sustain Partnerships:** Deepen engagement with existing sponsors — *German Imaging Technologies (GIT), The Design Gallery, and Victoria Furnitures Ltd* — while exploring new collaborations to expand resource support, technical expertise, and program reach. Continued partnership with these committed allies remains vital to YGAK's long-term success, stability, and credibility as we enter the 2026 program year.

This reflective review not only closes the 2025 calendar year but also sets a renewed strategic direction for 2026 — one anchored in continuous learning, innovation, and the unwavering belief that every seed planted brings Kenya closer to a greener, more sustainable future and also achieving our shared goal of planting 1 million trees by 2027.

Impact Overview (2022–2025).

Since 2022, *Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK)*, in partnership with *German Imaging Technologies (GIT), The Design Gallery, and Victoria Furnitures Ltd*, has continued to advance reforestation and environmental restoration across multiple counties in Kenya.

With the completion of the Homa Bay phase, YGAK has now planted a total of **705,000 trees** across Kenya — covering counties such as Nairobi, Kiambu, Elgeyo Marakwet, Kakamega, Narok, Bungoma, Trans Nzoia, Kajiado, Uasin Gishu, Kisumu, Mombasa, and now Homa Bay. This represents a **70.5%** achievement toward our shared target of planting **1 million trees by 2027**.

Acknowledgment.

Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) extends heartfelt appreciation to all participating schools, teachers, students, and community members in Homa Bay County who contributed to the success of this phase. Special thanks to our partners and sponsors — *German Imaging Technologies (GIT), The Design Gallery, and Victoria Furnitures Ltd* — for their continued support in driving YGAK's vision of environmental restoration, youth empowerment, and sustainable development across Kenya.

Conclusion.

The Homa Bay phase of the Greening Schools Initiative marks a significant step forward in YGAK's journey toward building a greener, more resilient Kenya. By promoting indigenous species and integrating climate education into schools, this phase reaffirms the role of youth and learning institutions in shaping a sustainable future. Through sustained partnerships and community engagement, YGAK remains committed to nurturing ecosystems, empowering young people, and advancing Kenya's climate action agenda.